

LASER MFDs

Monochrome Laser MFDs

Samsung SCX-4521F

Specifications

600 x 600 dpi optical resolution; flatbed and sheet-fed scanner; 150-sheet input tray; 2 MB memory; Ethernet port; USB 2.0 and parallel interfaces

Our Verdict

The Samsung SCX-4521F is Windows Imaging Architecture compliant—in English, this means you just connect it to a PC with Windows XP and it will be recognised; no need to install any drivers. OS support spans across Windows, Mac, and Linux. Print quality

is crisp, and the printer is relatively fast. It has the fastest scanner in its category with accurate scanning results. It continues its good run in the copying test as well, returning the lowest copying times and best quality. There are multiple modes of copying—ID card copy and poster copy. With an integrated Ethernet port and a toner duty cycle of 3,000 pages, the SCX-4521F is a good buy for SoHo users. It is not only a feature-rich performer, it comes with a good software bundle, increasing its value for money.

Runner-Up: Xerox WorkCentre PE220



INTEL MOTHERBOARDS

Intel 945G Express and 945GZ Express (Low-End)

ASRock Conroe 945G-DVI

Specifications

Support for LGA 775 CPU up to Core 2 Duo Extreme; onboard Intel graphics; 8-channel audio; maximum 4 GB DDR2 RAM; four SATA ports; Gigabit LAN; up to eight USB 2.0 ports

Our Verdict

The ASRock Conroe 945G-DVI is based on Intel's 945G chipset. Though designed for older Pentium D CPUs, with BIOS revision, this motherboard supports the latest Core 2 Duo

CPUs. It offers both onboard video and a PCIe slot. Though falling in the low-end category, the Conroe 945G-DVI scored quite close the newer, 965G-based motherboards that cost almost thrice as much! This board is very well-suited for most common applications like surfing, office suites, entertainment, and moderate gaming. The Conroe 945G-DVI motherboard gives truly amazing performance at a very low cost.

Runner-Up: Gigabyte GA-945GM-S2



Intel P965 Express and G965 Express (Mainstream)

Gigabyte GA-965P-DQ6

Specifications

Support for LGA 775 CPU up to Core 2 Quad; 8-channel HD audio; maximum 8 GB DDR2 RAM; CrossFire support; eight SATA ports; e-SATA support; SATA RAID support; Gigabit LAN; up to 10 USB 2.0 ports

Our Verdict

Based on Intel's latest P965 Express chipset, the Gigabyte's GA-965P-DQ6 offers support for Intel's latest Core 2 Quad CPUs. This board boasts of good gaming performance, thanks to CrossFire support. Eight SATA ports ensure you never run out of ports to connect your

hard drives. SATA RAID support lets you configure your hard drives to RAID 0, 1, 5, or 10. A passive heatsink covering the Northbridge and the Southbridge increases cooling efficiency. The use of solid-state capacitors also increases the life of the motherboard. The scores this board clocked clearly indicate that it is an ideal choice for those who intend to use their PC for gaming, 3D designing, or audio/video editing. Though a bit more expensive than the competition, strong performance and features bring in the Zero1 Award for the GA-965P-DQ6.

Runner-Up: MSI P965 Platinum

